“Christians will judge me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many people have experienced a cold look, a gossip circle, or a sermon that felt like a finger pointing at them. Some of us were judged for divorce, doubt, addiction, appearance, or politics. After that, it feels safer to expect judgment from every believer than to risk it again.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “Do not judge, or you will be judged,” and warned believers about the measure they use. When the woman caught in adultery stood before Him, He asked, “Woman, where are your accusers? Has no one condemned you?” Then He said, “neither do I condemn you.” James writes, “Mercy triumphs over judgment.” Paul adds that “there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.” Some Christians fail to reflect Jesus, but He does not fail to reflect Himself. The Savior who welcomed sinners is the standard, not the critics.

> *“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus”* (Romans 8:1).

Also see

> “‘Do not judge, or you will be judged. For with the same judgment you pronounce, you will be judged; and with the measure you use, it will be measured to you.’” (Matthew 7:1–2).

> “Then Jesus straightened up and asked her, ‘Woman, where are your accusers? Has no one condemned you?’ ‘No one, Lord,’ she answered. ‘Then neither do I condemn you,’ Jesus declared. ‘Now go and sin no more.’” (John 8:10–11).

> “For judgment without mercy will be shown to anyone who has not been merciful. Mercy triumphs over judgment” (James 2:13).

> “Brothers, if someone is caught in a trespass, you who are spiritual should restore him with a spirit of gentleness. But watch yourself, or you also may be tempted” (Galatians 6:1).

Common self-statements

- They will look down on me.
- Church people are hypocrites.
- If they knew, they would condemn me.
- I will be talked about.
- I do not meet their standards.
- It is safer to stay away.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating all Christians as judges because of some.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what they think.
- Fortune telling: Predicting condemnation before it happens.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling judged and concluding that I am.

Challenging questions

- Who judged me, and what exactly did they do or say?
- Have any Christians shown me grace?
- How did Jesus treat people others judged?
- Is judgment by some people a reason to avoid all people?
- What would a gracious community look like?
- Is there one safe person I could try again with?

Truth summary

> Jesus does not condemn me, and He calls His people to mercy, not judgment. Some Christians fall short of that, but I can look for those who reflect His grace. I do not have to let past judgment keep me from the fellowship God offers.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Judgmental
- Hypocritical
- Church
- Mercy
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Judgmental
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

This Is Amazing Grace — Phil Wickham
Christ bears the burden of rescue rather than demanding self-salvation.

Forgiveness — Matthew West
Ask God for help releasing resentment while working through real hurt.

Clean — Natalie Grant
God's cleansing grace challenges the belief that shame or sin makes a person beyond restoration.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Christians will judge me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Christians will judge me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who judged me?
- ☐ What did they say?
- ☐ Who has shown me grace?
- ☐ How did Jesus treat the judged?
- ☐ What would a gracious church look like?
- ☐ Who is one safe person?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ There is no condemnation in Christ.
- ☐ Mercy triumphs over judgment.
- ☐ Jesus welcomed sinners.
- ☐ Judgment by some does not define all.
- ☐ Grace-filled Christians exist.
- ☐ I can find a safe community.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ John 8:10–11
  "Then Jesus straightened up and asked her, 'Woman, where are your accusers? Has no one condemned you?' 'No one, Lord,' she answered. 'Then neither do I condemn you,' Jesus declared. 'Now go and sin no more.'"
- ☐ James 2:13
  "For judgment without mercy will be shown to anyone who has not been merciful. Mercy triumphs over judgment."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Grace seen: Each week, write one example of grace shown by a believer.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "There is no condemnation for me in Christ Jesus.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Judgmental" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Tell the story. Write what happened and how it made you feel.
- ☐ Read John 8:1–11. Notice how Jesus treated the accused.
- ☐ Look for grace. Find one believer who shows mercy and spend time with them.
- ☐ Forgive as you can. Pray for the people who judged you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Christians will judge me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Grace seen
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Christians will judge me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, You did not condemn the woman, and You do not condemn me. Heal the hurt from judgment and lead me to Your people who show mercy. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.